FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-05-19002

Issue Title : Lightning Strike Impact Reduction Program (LSIRP) - Composite Structure

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	0551-19	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Other Model(s)	ECCN
737NG	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
07/26/2019	07/26/2019	09/07/2018

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date
12/28/2020	10/28/2019

Applicability

737-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Description

The reference 737NG-FTD-51-16001 pertained to the Lightning Strike Impact Reduction Program (LSIRP)associated with lightning strike damage on metallic structure. This article provides a summary of Lightning Strike Impact Reduction Program (LSIRP) activities, status and progress for the composite structures project. The LSIRP is a Boeing technical team that has been assembled to investigate possible limited flight cycle relief after initial inspection of a 737NG/MAX, 747-8, 757, 767, 777, or 787 having experienced a lightning strike hit.

Background

The LSIRP was launched at the request of the European Aircraft Advisory Board (EAAB) in 2012 to mitigate the extensive downtime experienced by operators due to airplanes damaged by lightning strike hits. The LSIRP composite structures project is targeted to release a revision to the AMM end of 2020. The AMM revision will defer inspections of exterior composite structure for a number of flight cycles after a walk around ground inspection is performed.

The Lightning Strike Advisory Board consisting of airline operators was created and convenes bi-annually to provide project progress and acquire airline operator input. Airline Co-chairs are Diane Camp (Alaska Airlines) and Tahsin Istanbullu (Pegasus Airlines). Future meetings and locations will be announced with a Multi-Operator Message.

Status

- Airline lightning strike composite structure damage data collection. Ongoing

- Lightning strike damage characterization and data regression. Ongoing

- Fabrication of Trial Test Panel ECD Q3 of 2019

- Lightning Lab Test - Trial Test Panels - Establish current levels to replicate Fleet and ADL observed damage size. ECD of Q4 2019

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Interim Action

None required from information provided in this article.

Final Action

Boeing will provide a number of flight cycle operation guidance after a lightning strike in the AMM that will reduce airplane downtime.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

STG LSIRP Status Report: 16-October-2018 (complete)

Operator Action

None required from information provided in this article.

Part Information

No Parts Applied

Affected Documents

737NG/MAX AMM 05-51-19

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM)	05-51-19		
Fleet Team Digest Article (FTD)	737NG-FTD-51-16001		

Related Categories

- Dispatch Reliability Issues : Issues that cause revenue flight delays and cancellations
- Significant Technical Flight Interruptions : Issues that cause in-flight events such as rejected takeoffs, air turnbacks, diversions, emergency landings, in-flight shutdowns, and abnormal stops

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